

Everything went up, and the biggest move was not a stock

The week of August 3 to 7 was a straight line higher. The S and P 500 added **3.37 percent** and the Nasdaq 100 added **5.11 percent**. **Gold added 7.79 percent**, and that is the number worth sitting with.

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01 The week

Where the week finished, at the Friday August 7 settle.

+3.37% S&P 500, week	+5.11% Nasdaq 100, week	+3.38% Russell 2000, week	14.90 VIX, from 16.03	4.66% US 10 year	+7.79% Gold, week
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Five sessions, and four of them went the same way. The S and P futures opened the week at 7,550 and closed it at 7,777.

MON 3 ES 7,550 Week opens, futures basis OPEN	TUE 4 Record high ES prints 7,733 intraday TREND	WED 5 Two way Widest range day of the week RANGE	THU 6 Grind up No pushback from rates RALLY	FRI 7 ES 7,777 Closes near the highs CLOSE
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Green top means the session closed higher, red means lower, grey means flat.

02 The gold problem

When every index rises and gold rises more, the two are not saying the same thing.

- **Gold rose 7.79 percent in five sessions, from 4,083 to 4,401 dollars.** That is a bigger move than any of the three big stock indexes made.
- Stocks rising is a bet that companies earn more. **Gold rising is a bet that money buys less.** Both cannot be the main story at once.
- The usual explanation for both together is **more money in the system**, rather than better business. Prices go up because the measuring stick shrinks.

- **This is the week's one genuinely unusual fact.** A 3 percent index week is ordinary. An 8 percent gold week alongside it is not.

03 The convoy, again

The index reports the lead trucks. The tail tells you the health.

- (Cap weighted (the S&P 500 you see quoted: big companies count more)) rose **3.37 percent**. The **same 500 companies weighted equally** rose **1.95 percent**.
- **The gap is 1.4 points in one week**, and it points the same way it did the week before. The largest companies are carrying the number.
- The Nasdaq 100 at **plus 5.11 percent** is the cleanest read on that. It is the index with the fewest and biggest names.
- **Small companies did keep up this week**, at plus 3.38 percent. That is the healthier signal in the data and it is worth naming.

04 Calm, and cheaper oil

Two supporting facts, both quiet, both helpful.

- (VIX (the market expectation of swing over the next month, priced from options)) **fell from 16.03 to 14.90**, having touched 18.43 midweek. **Fear was priced and then unpriced.**
- The US 10 year finished at **4.66 percent**, effectively unchanged. Borrowing costs did not move against the rally.
- **Crude fell 3.77 percent to 77.08 dollars**, with a low of 74.24. Cheaper energy is a tailwind for almost every company that is not an oil company.
- Nothing in the rates or energy picture argued with the rally. **That is rarer than it sounds.**

05 What it means

The plain reading, without a forecast attached.

- **A 3 percent week with falling volatility and flat yields is a market with nothing pushing back on it.**
- **The S and P futures ran 7,542 to 7,820 and closed at 7,777.** Almost the entire range was made going one direction.
- The honest caution is the gold line. **A market can rise because business is good or because money is loose, and only one of those compounds.**

THE ONE LINE

Every index rose and gold rose more. When the safe asset outruns the risky ones in the same week, the rally is about the money, not the companies.

SOURCES & NOTE

Sources: Index, futures, volatility, rates and commodity levels: Yahoo Finance daily bars, August 3 to 7 2026, pulled August 7; Cap weighted against equal weighted: the S and P 500 index compared with RSP, the equal weight fund; Full weekly audit: 2-Areas/trading/7-weekly/2026-08-09-recap.md.

Educational, not financial advice. A record of what the market did in one week, written to be read by someone who does not trade.

Glossary

Cap weighted An index where bigger companies count for more. The S and P 500 you see quoted is this one.

Equal weighted The same companies counted the same. Comparing the two tells you whether a rally is broad.

VIX The market expectation of swing over the next 30 days, priced from options. Low means calm is being assumed.

Yield What a government bond pays. Rising yields mean borrowing costs more for everyone underneath.

WTI West Texas Intermediate, the main US crude oil benchmark.

Futures A contract to buy or sell later at a price agreed now. The S and P version trades nearly around the clock.

Safe asset Something bought for protection rather than growth. Gold and government bonds are the usual two.
